

SWB EVALUATION · PROJECT 297

BFWAI Container Farming Training Initiative

*Comprehensive findings on demographics, satisfaction, knowledge acquisition,
farming outcomes, and recommendations for future program design*

217 Participants · 4 Villages / Sites

Beellahy Foundation Initiative

Five findings that should shape what comes next

2.72/5

Overall satisfaction — with clear, statistically significant differences by village ($p < 0.001$)

35.7%

Mean knowledge score — despite self-reported training improvement of 3.75/5

$\rho = 0.18$

Age, not farming experience, predicts field application of knowledge ($p = 0.007$)

U-shaped

4–10 years of experience band is the most underserved 'middle tier' in met expectations

39%

Of participants with full harvest sufficiency still doubt long-term viability

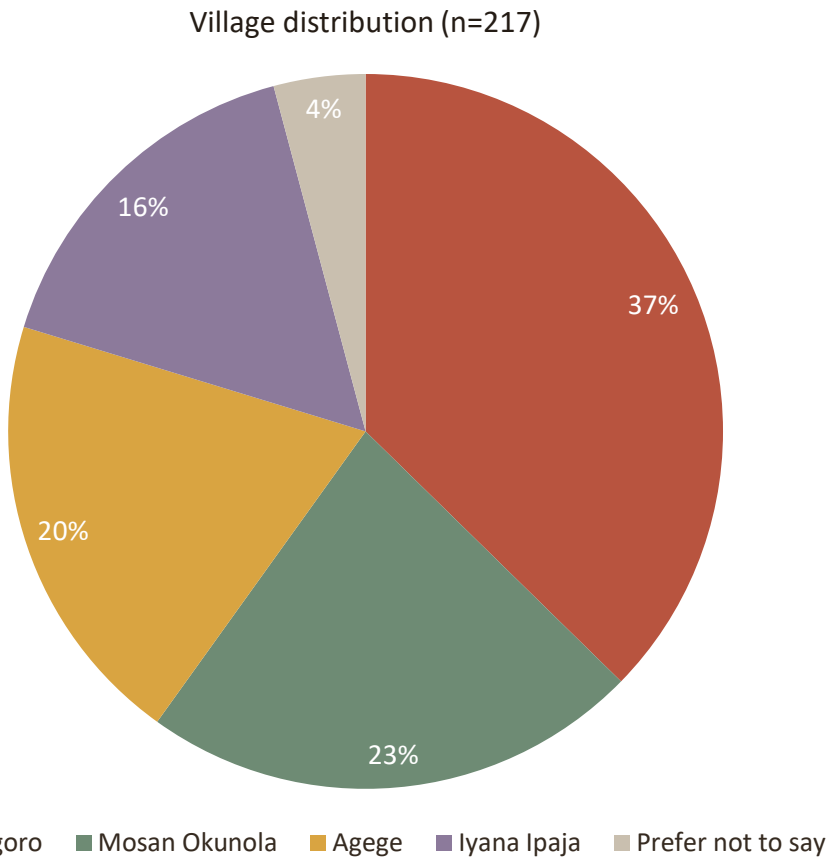
45% / 33%

Want financial assistance / more advanced training — not basic farming knowledge

Village of residence is the single strongest predictor of both overall and support satisfaction (ANOVA $p < 0.001$ for both) — pointing to geographic proximity to Foundation staff, more than individual characteristics, as the key driver of experience quality.

PARTICIPANT DEMOGRAPHICS

217 participants, concentrated in Mangoro



VILLAGE BREAKDOWN		
Mangoro	81	37%
Mosan Okunola	49	23%
Agege	43	20%
Iyana Ipaja	35	16%
Prefer not to say	9	4%

76.5%

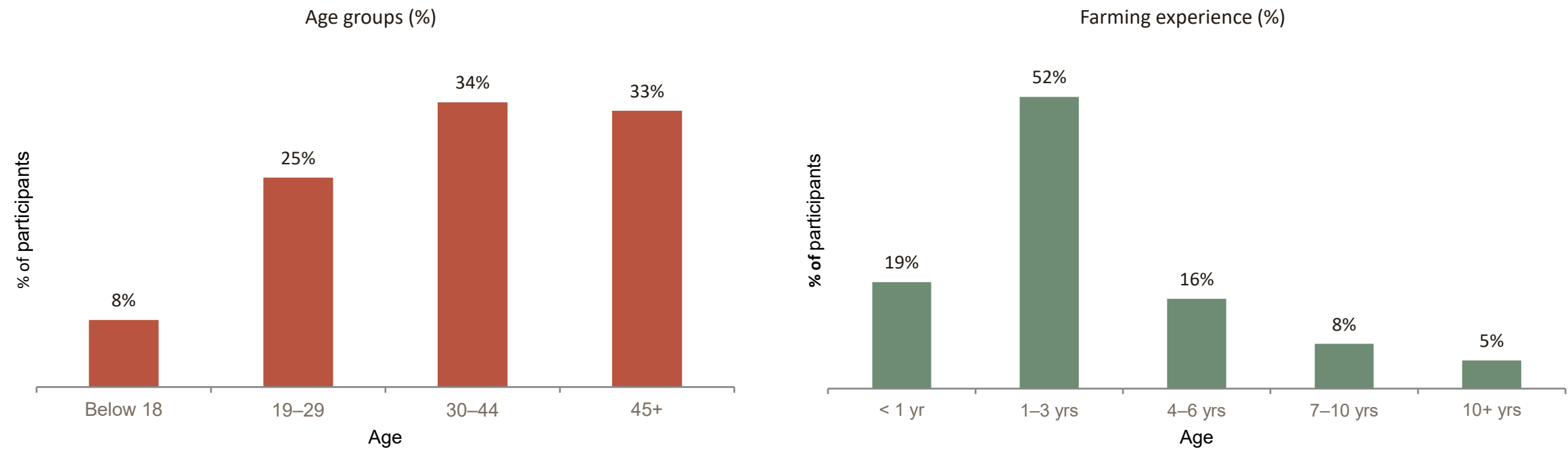
of participants are female

4

villages / sites covered

The sample skews strongly towards females and is concentrated in Mangoro — relevant when weighing whether findings generalise evenly across sites.

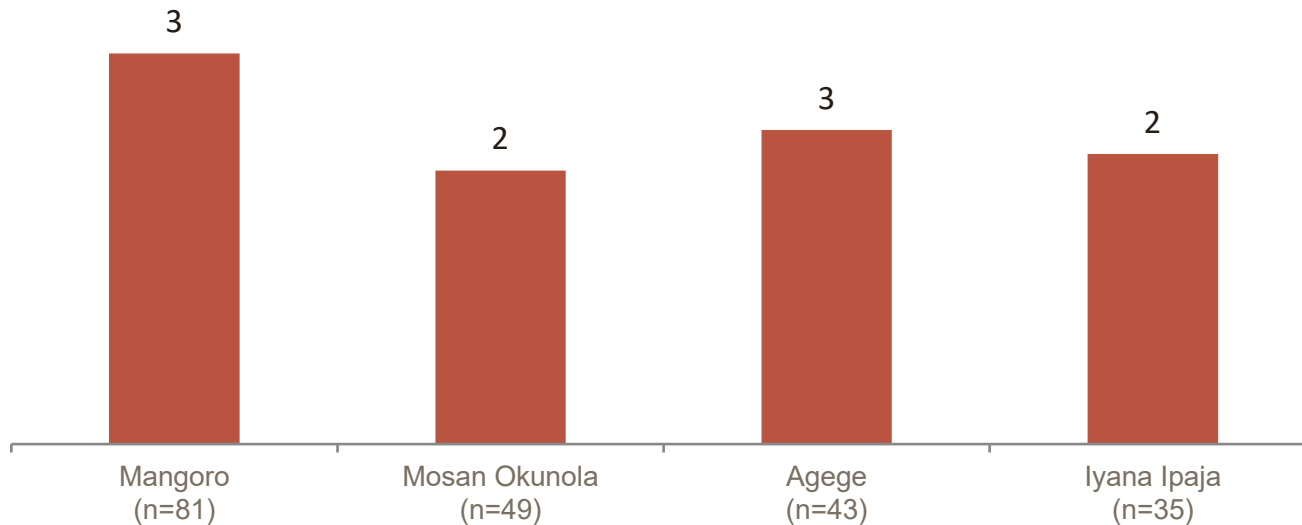
Young in tenure, not necessarily young in age



52% of participants have just 1–3 years of experience — a relatively young program cohort in tenure, though not in age (67% are 30+). Mangoro has the deepest bench of longer-tenured farmers, while Agege and Iyana Ipaja skew toward newer entrants — relevant for village-specific mentorship rollout.

Where you live predicts how satisfied you are

Overall satisfaction by village (out of 5)



Village location explains roughly 9.8% of the variance in satisfaction scores — a real, statistically significant effect.

Mangoro (3.27) sits significantly above Mosan Okunola (2.29) and Agege (2.63).

Likely driver: geographic proximity to Beellahy Foundation staff.

SATISFACTION LEVELS

Support works best when reached; the question is, reach.

2.72/5

average satisfaction with
ongoing support & monitoring
(n=217)

63%

of participants, could access Foundation
support when needed

3.41/5

ease of access, among those who had access

9.8%

The satisfaction variance explained by the
village

WHEN MATERIALS DIDN'T FULLY ANSWER QUESTIONS

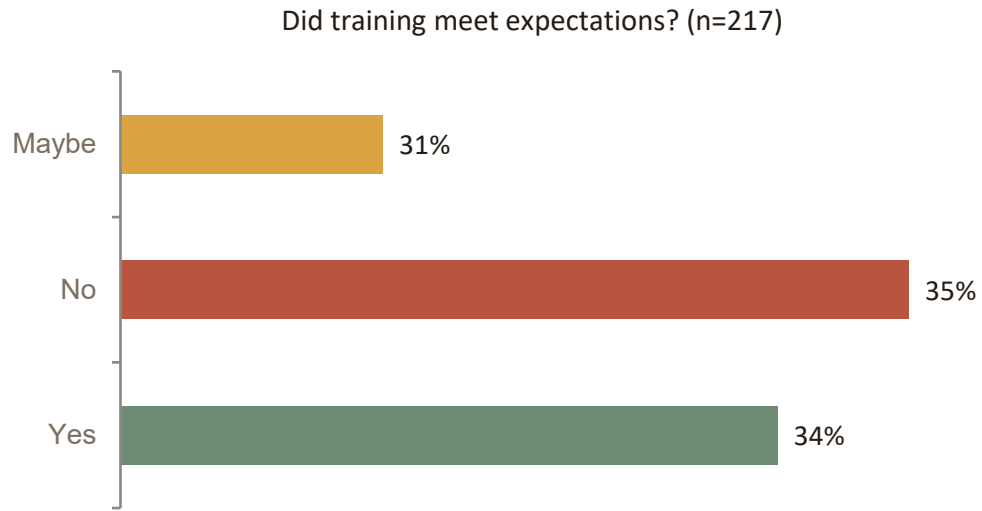
78% of respondents said additional information sources were 'not applicable' — primarily because training materials already answered their questions.

But for the remaining 42% whose questions weren't fully answered, the fallback options were thin:

10% → Online sources **8% → Foundation staff directly**

As with overall satisfaction, support satisfaction is significantly predicted by village — Mangoro again outperforms Mosan Okunola and Agege.

The middle-experience tier is the least served



3.36/5 satisfaction when expectations were met, vs. **2.25/5** when they weren't
($p < 0.001$)

60% reported encountering no challenges during training overall.

THE U-SHAPED PATTERN

Met-expectations rate follows a U-shape by experience:

Newcomers → satisfied

4–10 years → least satisfied

Veterans (10+) → satisfied

Challenge rates also rise steadily with age: *only 11% of under-18 participants report challenges, compared with 24–39% among older groups.*

It's age, not experience, that predicts real-world use

AGE — SIGNIFICANT

p = 0.007

Under-30 participants apply knowledge noticeably less (mean 2.74–2.78/5) than those 30 and older (mean 3.24–3.28/5) — regardless of years farming.

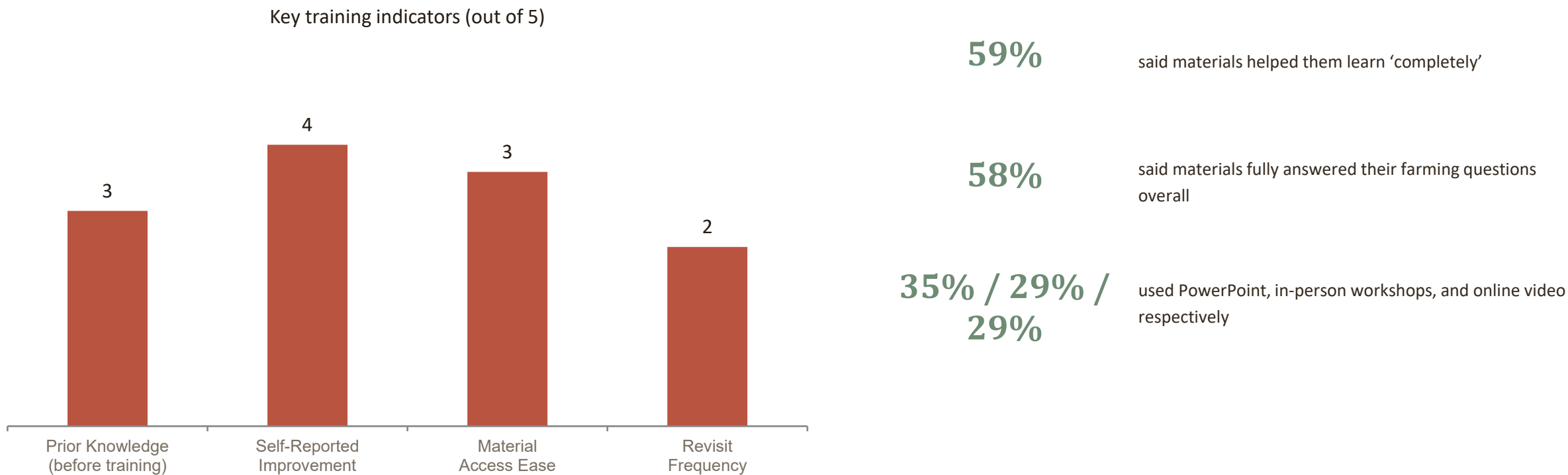
EXPERIENCE — NOT SIGNIFICANT

p = 0.535

Years of farming experience do not predict whether knowledge is applied in the field — a genuinely counterintuitive result.

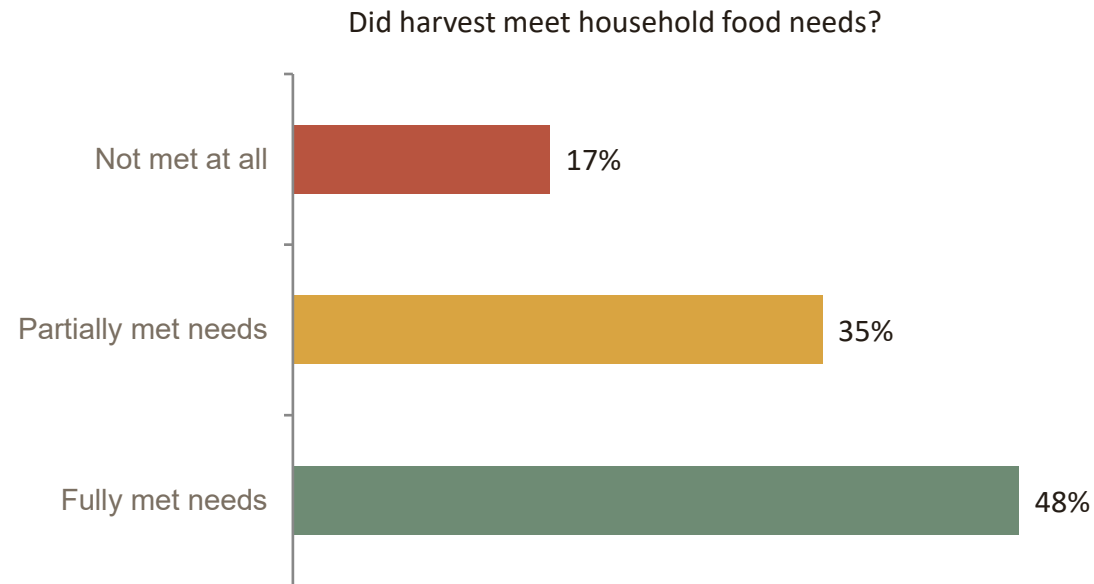
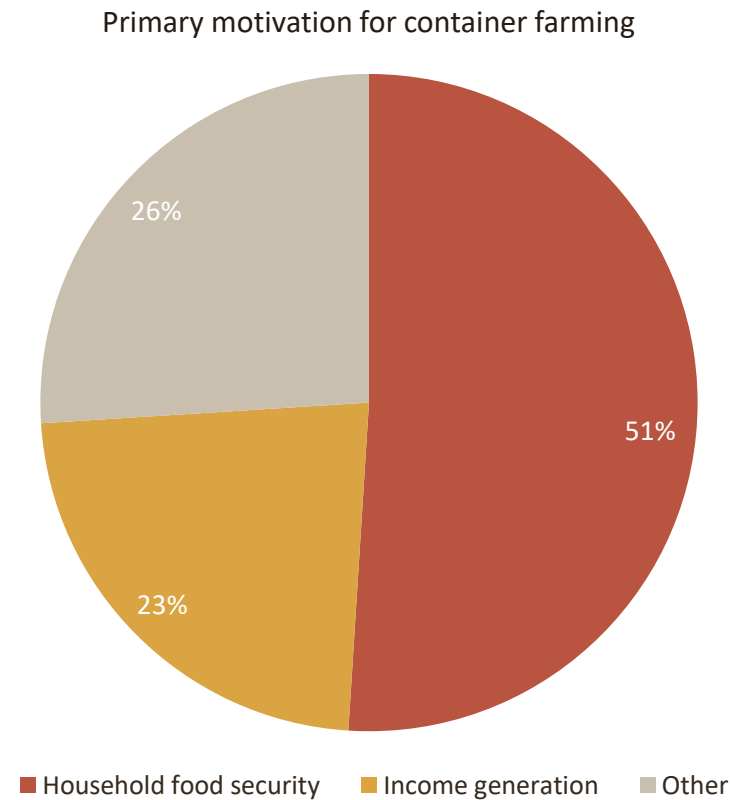
A second, weaker finding compounds this: more farming experience is associated with slightly lower knowledge test scores (each step up in experience decreases score by 2.4 points; $R^2 = 0.028$, $F = 6.25$, $p = 0.013$). *This effect is weak — experience explains under 3% of variance — and should not be read as experience being harmful. More likely, newer/younger entrants simply received more recent, concentrated instruction.*

Perceived learning outpaces practical coverage



Materials are easy to access (3.39/5) but rarely revisited (2.39/5) — participants have access, but don't return to reinforce learning. Mangoro and older age groups were more likely to say materials fully answered their questions than Iyana Ipaja or under-18 participants.

Food security drives participation; harvests are mixed



52%

of participants were able to sell surplus harvest — a meaningful but incomplete majority, and the key gateway to income (not just subsistence) benefits

Growing well doesn't mean believing it will last

39%

of participants with full harvest sufficiency still doubt long-term viability

58%

of partial-harvest participants are ambiguous — answering 'Maybe' or 'Not sure'

40%

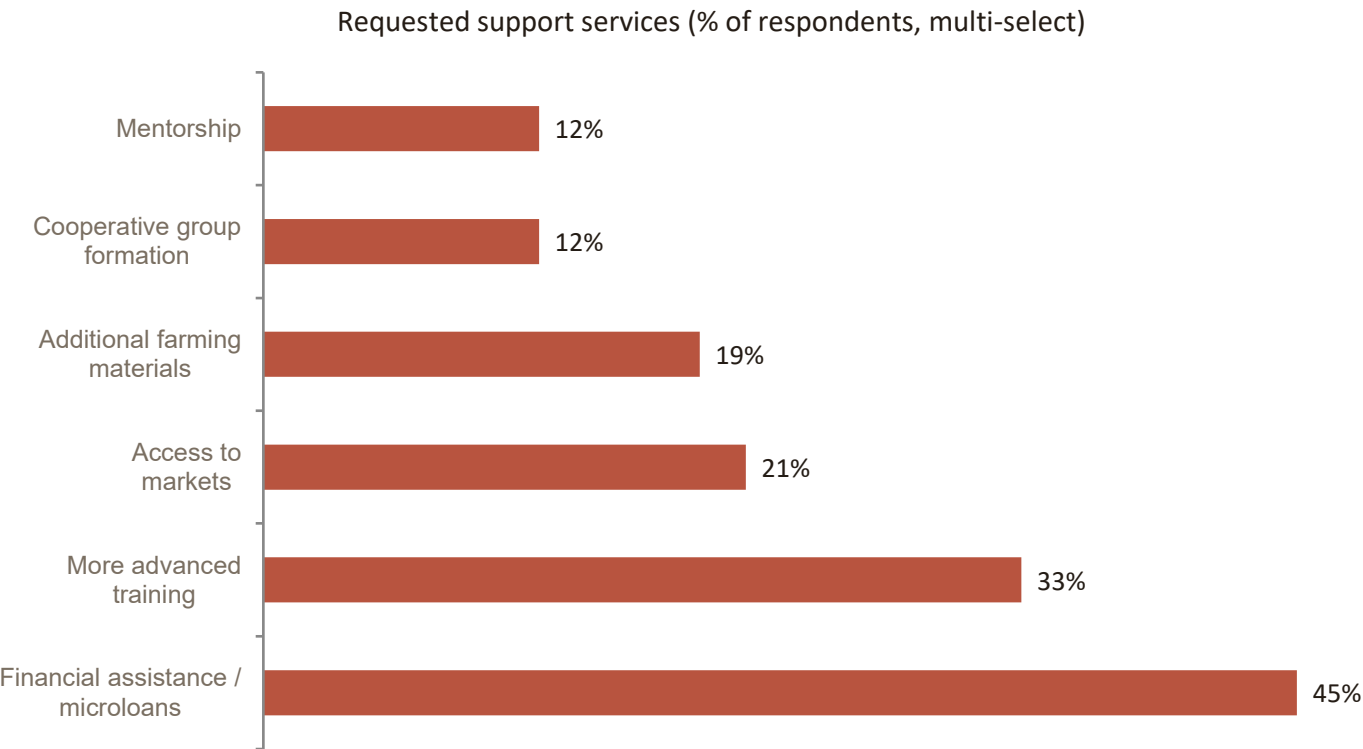
of those unable to sell surplus, say 'No' to future viability

Statistical basis: viability belief is tied to both harvest sufficiency ($p < 0.001$) and ability to sell surplus ($p = 0.044$).

KEY INSIGHT

Production success $\neq$ belief in viability. The participant's doubts appear to be structural rather than personal — tied to market access for selling surplus rather than their growing capability itself. This points to market-access support as the more binding constraint on long-term confidence, rather than a lack of additional farming instruction.

What participants want next: capital and markets



80%

applied knowledge to 'some extent' or better

63%

rated training pace/demonstration as 'adequate'

55% / 25%

said Yes / No interest in future training

A meaningful 25% minority isn't interested in further training — program design should address why, not just serve the 55% who are.

MENTOR-MENTEE MATCHING POTENTIAL

A ready-made mentorship pool — unevenly distributed



Mentors and potential mentors show markedly higher knowledge-application scores (3.16 and 3.30) than mentees and potential mentees (2.89 and 2.48) — confirming that age × experience pairing captures a real, usable gap.



Four moves to convert knowledge into income

1 Market Access & Capital

Prioritize market-linkage support (cooperatives, buyer connections, transport) and pair it with financial assistance / microloans — the single most-requested service (45%). Inability to sell surplus is the strongest predictor of doubt in the program.

2 Village-Targeted Support

Investigate why Mosan Okunola and Iyana Ipaja lag behind Mangoro despite similar content. Increase in-person touchpoints where satisfaction is lowest.

3 A Distinct Mid-Experience Track

Build an explicit 'advanced training' pathway for the underserved 4–10-year experience band (33% of all participants want more advanced training). Launch formal mentorship (38 confirmed mentors, 47 mentees), piloting in balanced Agege before mentee-heavy or mentor-heavy villages.

4 Reinforce Materials, Engage Youth

Revisit frequency is the lowest-scoring indicator (2.39/5) — add SMS reminders, refresher sessions, or recap videos. Design age-appropriate engagement for under-30s, who apply knowledge less regardless of experience, and follow up with the 25% not interested in further training.

SUMMARY TAKEAWAY

Knowledge delivery works. Three structural gaps limit impact.

- 1 Market access to convert harvests into income
- 2 Uneven support reaches across villages
- 3 A mismatched offering for mid-experience farmers

Addressing these — alongside formal mentorship and better material reinforcement — is likely to yield more impact than additional basic training content alone.